Handled × Simply Business

A partnership proposal

Prepared for: Simply Business, Partnerships & Distribution team
Prepared by: [Your name], [Title], Handled Services LLC · info@handledsvc.com · (313) 639-9373
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1. The short version

Handled is an AI-run home and business services company based in Detroit. We sell the job to the customer, then send it to vetted independent pros: cleaners, landscapers, handymen, painters, power washers, pet-care pros, haulers and licensed trades.

Every Handled pro must carry general liability insurance and give us a certificate of insurance (COI) naming Handled as additional insured before they get a single job. Many of the people who apply are new solo businesses with no policy yet. Today they have to go and find one on their own, and some never come back.

Those are exactly the businesses Simply Business already insures. We'd like Simply Business to be the **recommended insurance partner built into Handled's pro onboarding**, plus four further ways to work together (section 3):

	What Simply Business gets	What Handled gets
Customers	A steady flow of new small-business policies in your core classes (cleaning, janitorial, landscaping, handyman, painting, pet care). These buyers *have* to buy to start earning.	Pros get insured and working in days, not weeks
Retention	We check every pro's COI on a schedule and flag expiring coverage, so renewals come back to you	Fewer pros lost to lapsed coverage
Growth	Your policyholders get paid work through Handled, so their businesses grow, which means higher limits, more lines and longer customer lifetimes	Pre-insured, ready-to-work supply
Revenue	Lower acquisition cost than paid search for the same classes	Referral income + co-marketing

What we're asking for: a 90-day pilot in Metro Detroit with a tracked referral link and a named Simply Business partner contact. If it works, we roll it out to every city Handled launches in.

2. Why this fits Simply Business

From the public record:

- **Simply Business is a small-business insurance marketplace** (US headquarters in Boston, part of Travelers). Owners compare quotes from several carriers and buy online: general liability, professional liability, BOP, workers' comp, commercial auto, cyber and more.
- **You grow through distribution partners.** Recent examples: carriers and MGAs (Arch, RLI, Coterie, Appalachian Underwriters), agency networks (SIAA MarketFinder, First Connect), and gig and lead platforms. Thumbtack, for example, sends its pros to Simply Business for insurance quotes.
- **Our trades are your core classes.** You run dedicated pages for cleaners, janitorial, landscaping, handyman and contractors, with GL starting at about $20–26/month.

Handled is the same kind of distribution channel as Thumbtack, with one important difference:

> **A Thumbtack pro *might* buy insurance. A Handled pro *must* buy insurance to get paid, and we check the certificate.** The referral arrives at the moment of highest intent, with the coverage need already defined: which trade, which limits, and who needs to be additional insured.

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3. Five ways to work together

① Recommended insurance partner in pro onboarding (the pilot)

- Handled's pro onboarding (`/pros` → `/pro/onboarding`) and our Pro Program page already have an "insurance partner" slot. We set Simply Business as that partner with a tracked link and referral code.
- When a pro reaches the insurance step without a COI, they see: *"Get covered in minutes with Simply Business."* The quote is pre-filled with their trade, state and the limits Handled requires (GL $1M per occurrence; commercial auto or workers' comp where their trade needs it).
- Our onboarding, Indeed recruiting posts and pro welcome packet all name Simply Business as the partner.
- **Handled earns:** your standard referral or affiliate fee per qualified lead or bound policy.

② COI verification and renewal loop (retention for Simply Business)

- Handled's back office checks every pro's insurance and flags certificates **30 days before they expire**.
- Pros insured through Simply Business get a renewal reminder that links back to their Simply Business account, not to a competitor.
- **Phase 2:** a certificate API or email feed, so additional-insured COIs for Handled are issued and checked automatically, with no PDF chasing on either side.

③ Co-funded "First Policy" credit

- Handled already pays proven pros a one-time **$150 insurance stipend** after their 10th job.

- **Proposal:** Handled moves that stipend forward as a *premium credit for pros who buy through Simply Business*. If you're willing, Simply Business matches part of it as a new-customer offer. The pro pays less to start working, Simply Business wins the policy, and Handled gets a working pro sooner.

④ Jobs for Simply Business customers (supply, from you to us)

- Many Simply Business policyholders are solo cleaners, landscapers and handymen who want more steady work.
- **"Simply Business Verified" fast track:** your customers who join Handled skip the insurance-verification wait and get first-week priority on job offers.
- Simply Business can offer it as a free member benefit: *"Insured with us? Get pre-paid jobs through Handled."*
- **Simply Business earns:** through Handled's existing Referral Partner Program, **10% of Handled's take on every job the referred pro or customer does for 12 months**, paid weekly by Stripe. Busier customers also tend to keep their policies and raise their limits.

⑤ New-business bundle (formation, websites, AI back office)

- Handled's Business & Technology services include **business formation (LLC setup), websites and AI automation** for small businesses.
- Every new business we form or build a website for gets a Simply Business quote at launch. An LLC with no insurance is the most natural lead there is.
- Going the other way, Simply Business can list Handled's website and AI services as a perk in the policyholder resource hub. We pay the same 10% referral share.

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4. How it works in practice

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Pro applies to Handled ─► trade, area & license checked ─► insurance step
                                                                  │
                          has COI? ── yes ─► verified ─► gets jobs
                                    └─ no ─► "Get covered with Simply Business" (tracked, pre-filled)
                                                  │
                                 policy bound ─► COI names Handled ─► verified ─► gets jobs
                                                  │
                               30 days before expiry ─► reminder ─► renews with Simply Business
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Set-up effort: Handled's side is configuration only: partner name, link, phone and referral code in our Hub, plus copy changes. On Simply Business's side we need a tracked link (or partner-API access), a partner contact, and approval on co-branded wording.

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5. The money (illustrative)

These scenarios assume **60% of approved pros arrive without suitable coverage** and **35% of those buy through the recommended partner**. Per-referral value uses the publicly listed US affiliate rate of

≈$50 per qualified lead (to be confirmed). Premium uses **≈$600/year** for a solo-trade GL policy, in line with your advertised $20–50/month range for these classes.

Pros approved by Handled / year	Referred to Simply Business	New policies bound	First-year premium written for Simply Business	Referral income to Handled (≈$50/lead)
250 (Detroit pilot year)	150	~53	~$32K	~$7.5K
1,000 (3–4 cities)	600	~210	~$126K	~$30K
5,000 (national roll-out)	3,000	~1,050	~$630K	~$150K

Not included above, and where most of the long-term value is:

- **Renewals and add-on lines** (commercial auto, workers' comp as pros hire, tools and equipment). The COI renewal loop protects these.
- **Handled's business clients** (offices, property managers, HOAs, restaurants) and the new LLCs we form, all of which need BOP or GL.
- **Simply Business's 10% share** of Handled's take on jobs done by referred pros and customers (path ④).

We're open to a per-lead fee, a revenue share on bound premium, or a hybrid, whichever fits your partner program.

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6. Why Handled is a good partner

- **We control the moment of need.** Insurance is a hard gate in our software and in our contractor agreement, not an optional upsell.
- **Our pros are already vetted.** Every pro passes trade, license, background and area checks before the insurance step. You get cleaner, lower-risk small-business customers.
- **Quality data on every job.** We collect before-and-after photos and run AI quality checks on every job. Pros with repeat redos lose access to work, so the pros we send you are actively managed.
- **Partnering is part of how we operate.** We already run a Referral Partner Program with automatic weekly payouts, and we bring in carrier partners such as 3 Lakes Logistics the same way.
- **We're built to scale.** Handled is AI-run, so onboarding volume grows with each city we open without a matching increase in headcount.

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7. Proposed next steps

When	Step
Week 1	Intro call: confirm the partner path (affiliate, referral agreement or partner API) and the commercial terms
Week 2	Simply Business issues a tracked link or code; Handled adds it to onboarding, the Pro Program and recruiting
Weeks 3–14	**90-day Detroit pilot.** Shared monthly report: referrals, quotes, policies bound, time from application to first job
Day 90	Review together. If targets are met, sign a multi-city agreement and scope phase 2 (COI API, co-funded credit, Verified fast track)

Pilot success measures: at least 50% of uninsured approved pros click through; at least 30% bind; median time from “approved” to “insured and working” under 5 days.

Contact [Your name] · [Title], Handled Services LLC
info@handledsvc.com · (313) 639-9373 · Detroit, Michigan

Handled is a services marketplace, not an insurance agency. Handled does not sell, solicit or give advice on insurance. Insurance quotes, coverage advice and policies come from Simply Business and its licensed carriers. Any referral fee arrangement will be set up in line with state producer-licensing rules, and both parties’ counsel will confirm the structure before launch.